Punjab. We can grow maize, barley, millets and other crops. Our land is fertile, but we neither have marketing infrastructure nor assured MSP procurement. We will create cooperatives and reduce production costs.

BADAL: Farmers should have a guaranteed market and price. Unless the Centre guarantees MSP purchase of, say, maize, farmers will not diversify. They should allow ethanol in a big way. States should have enough financial power to support these initiatives.

AMARINDER: Punjab's mainstay in agriculture is paddy, which India does not need any more as we have got plenty stored. India is importing pulses worth Rs 1.5 lakh crore every year. Give me Rs 25,000 crore out of this sum and we will persuade farmers to shift from paddy to pulses. We will get paddy out of the way and also save water.

Q. What needs to be done for industrial development?

CHANNI: Agricultural output is at its peak in Punjab. We have done what we could do. Now, we need to shift gear towards agro industries and focus on industrialisation. From cottage to big industry, we need revival. We need support from the Centre. Ours is a border state. We need incentives, and the Centre should look into it.



"The Akalis gave Punjab good roads, new power plants. We are the only Punjabi party in the fray"

SUKHBIR BADAL

MANN: Traders are moving around with bags full of money for politicians. They aren't doing so out of admiration. Traders are going to politicians across the spectrum to please them and ensure that they don't come after them upon assuming power. Governments are not formed to harass people. But these days, traders fear for their success. Mandi Gobindgarh used to be a steel hub. Not anymore. We will change this. We will woo industry from Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and other states.

BADAL: We will focus on the priority sectors. IT is one such sector as its potential in South India is exhausted. If IT firms move north, we can offer them the best locations, international airports, good hotels. We need to promote tourism in a big way. We will start 2 or 3 big projects to develop food processing. Within a year of coming to power, I will ensure a paperless government towards ease of doing business. Once you make the process paperless, 99 per cent of corruption and hindrances will be over. Industrialists, and not bureaucrats, should frame industrial policies because that will make them accountable.

AMARINDER: The main thing is that we need money and policies that encourage industry to come to Punjab.

Q. What is your view about your opponents?

CHANNI: Sukhbir Badal is arrogant and relies on muscle power. All members of his family are involved in politics. He is only a good businessman. Bhagwant Mann is no challenge; he is a mere rubber stamp. Even AAP posters ask people to give Kejriwal an opportunity. By choosing Captain Sahib as its face, the BJP has damaged its reputation. He will get no seats in this election.



"I offer experience. I have been in this game for 50 years and know what my state requires"

AMARINDER SINGH

MANN: The mafia in Punjab is a creation of the Badals. Amarinder Singh took it one step forward. It's evident that they work in tandem. Captain Sahib made a joke of the people's verdict. Charanjit Channi claims he is a commoner but has declared property worth over Rs 110 crore. He is a fake *aam aadmi*.

BADAL: Charanjit Channi is a nobody. He is neither charismatic nor has statewide appeal. Channi may lose both the seats he is contesting from. Captain Sahib's alliance with the BJP is zero plus zero equals zero. Regarding Bhagwant Mann, I dread the day people like him are chosen to lead the state. He is just a drunkard.

AMARINDER: There is no doubt that people feel the need for a change, but you need someone of competence to bring that about. Bhagwant Mann is incapable of running the state. All he has done is stand up and crack jokes. About Sukhbir Badal, the people have not forgotten the sacrilege issue and the narcotics problem. Charanjit Channi has limited capabilities. He lacks the bandwidth to be a chief minister. ■